# PARISHRAM 2.0

## CLASS 12TH 2026

# The Third Level

(Vistas)

ENGLISH LECTURE 01

BY-NIHARIKA MA'AM



# TOPICS TO BE COVERED

1 The Third Level

↓

Vistas

writer - Jack Finney

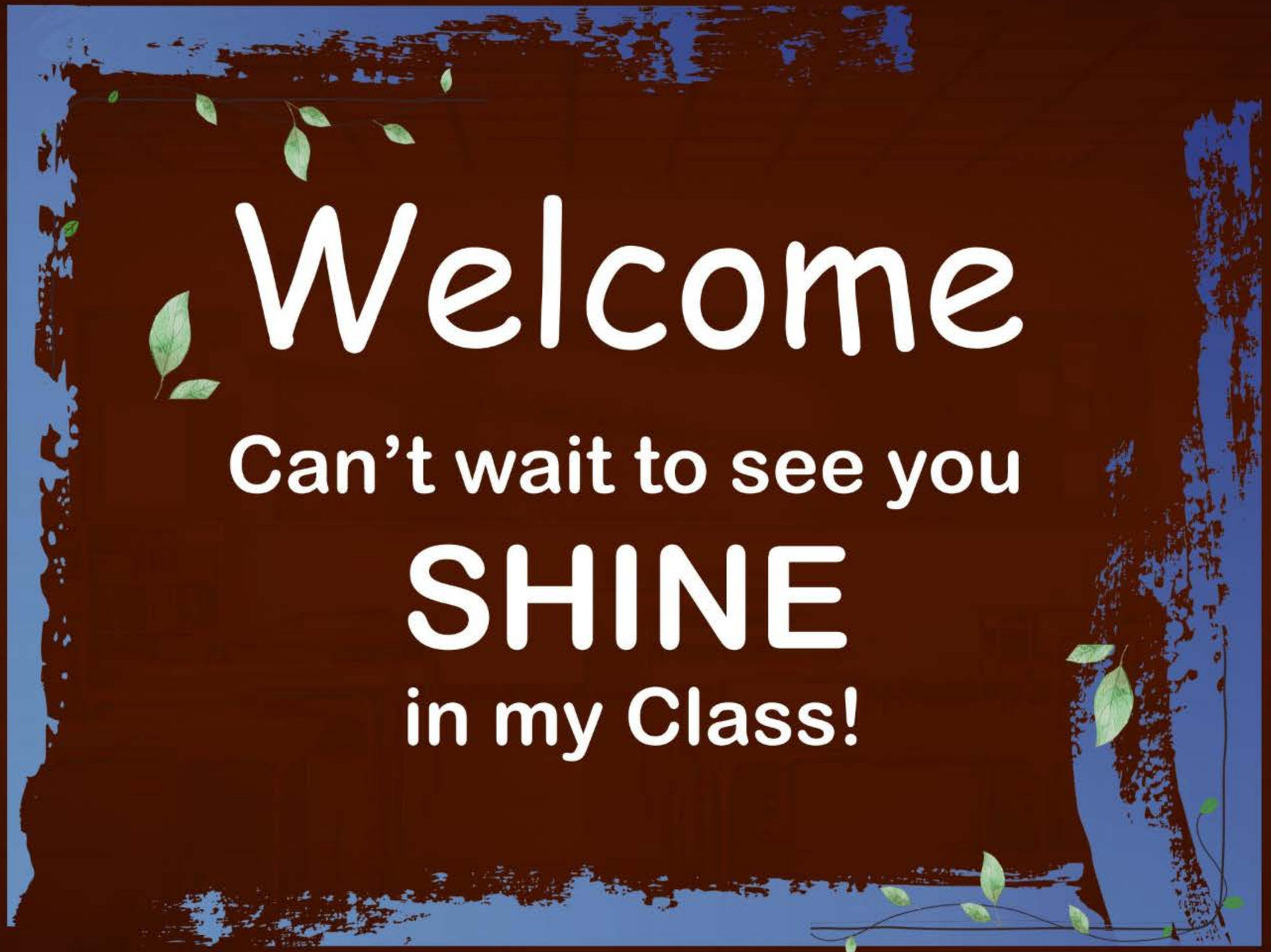
↓

(Sci-fi) // imaginary

// Word wheel //

Time Travel


WELCOME TO OUR TEAM
English
Rocket
Raccoon
YOU ARE GOING TO LOVE
IT HERE!


Welcome
Can’t wait to see you
SHINE
in my Class!

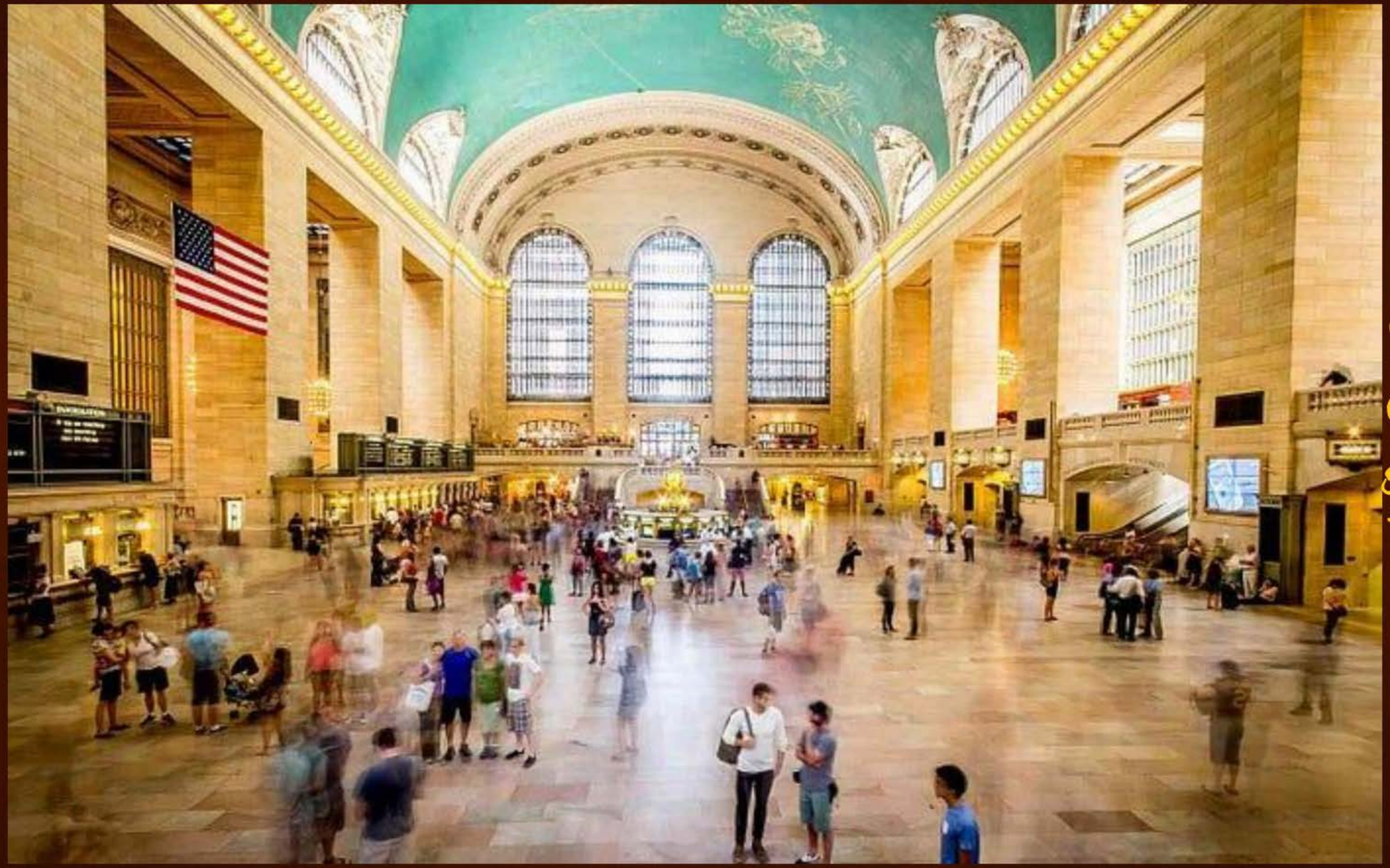
# Topic : The Third Level

**Before you read**

Have you ever had any curious experience which others find hard to believe?




Time
endless
loop
5
D A R K
NETFLIX

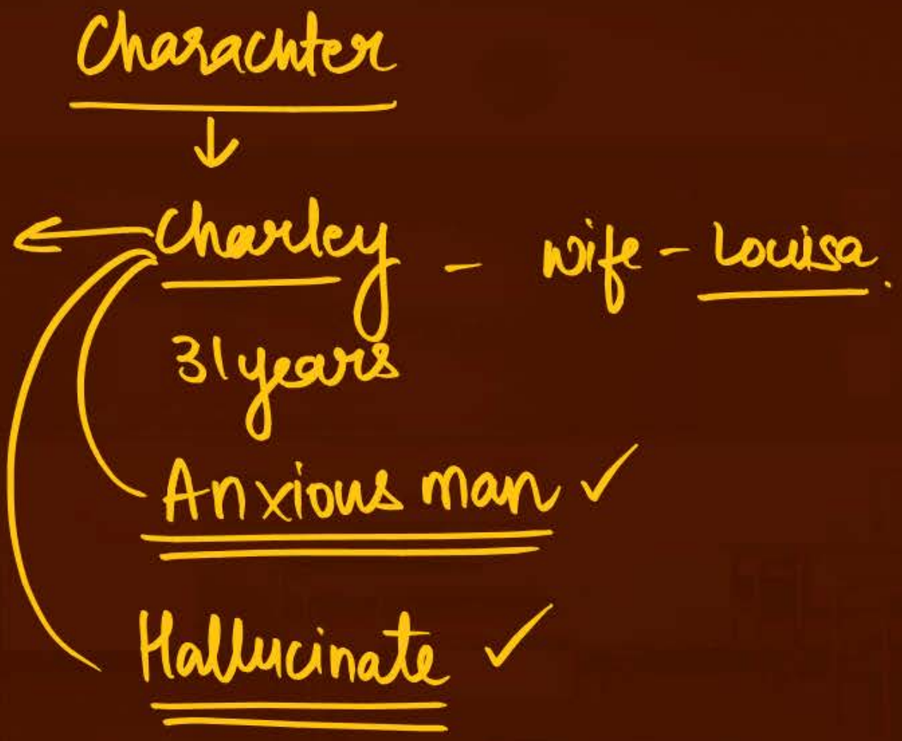


grand central station



3rd level

psychiatrist


Character
Charley - wife - Louisa.
31 years
Anxious man ✓
Hallucinate ✓



1st level
20th century trains




- 2nd level
(Suburban trains)



derby hat





Handlebar moustache



mutton sleeves clothes







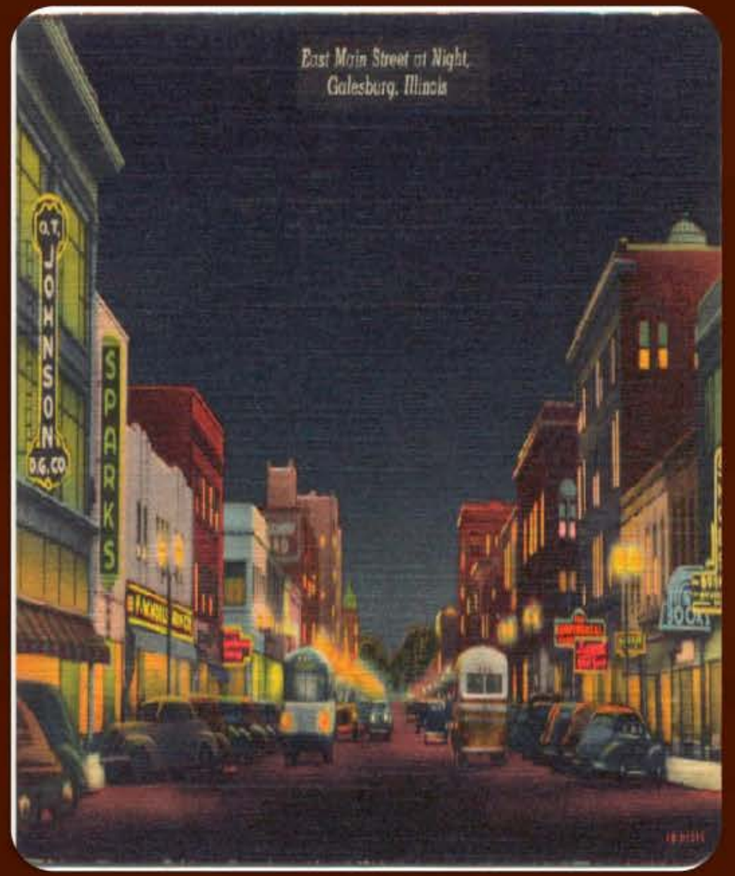


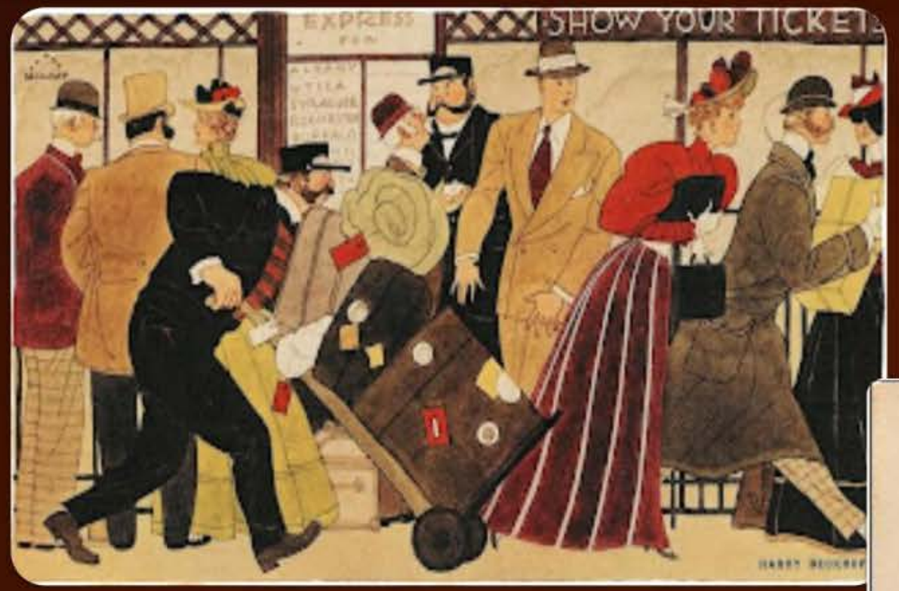




GALESBURG


NORTH PRAIRIE STREET, GALESBURG, ILL.


East Main Street at Night,
Galesburg, Illinois
O.T. JOHNSON DG.CO
SPARKS




प्रथम दिवस आवरण
FIRST DAY COVER
1-10-67



भारत छोड़ो 1942 QUIT INDIA

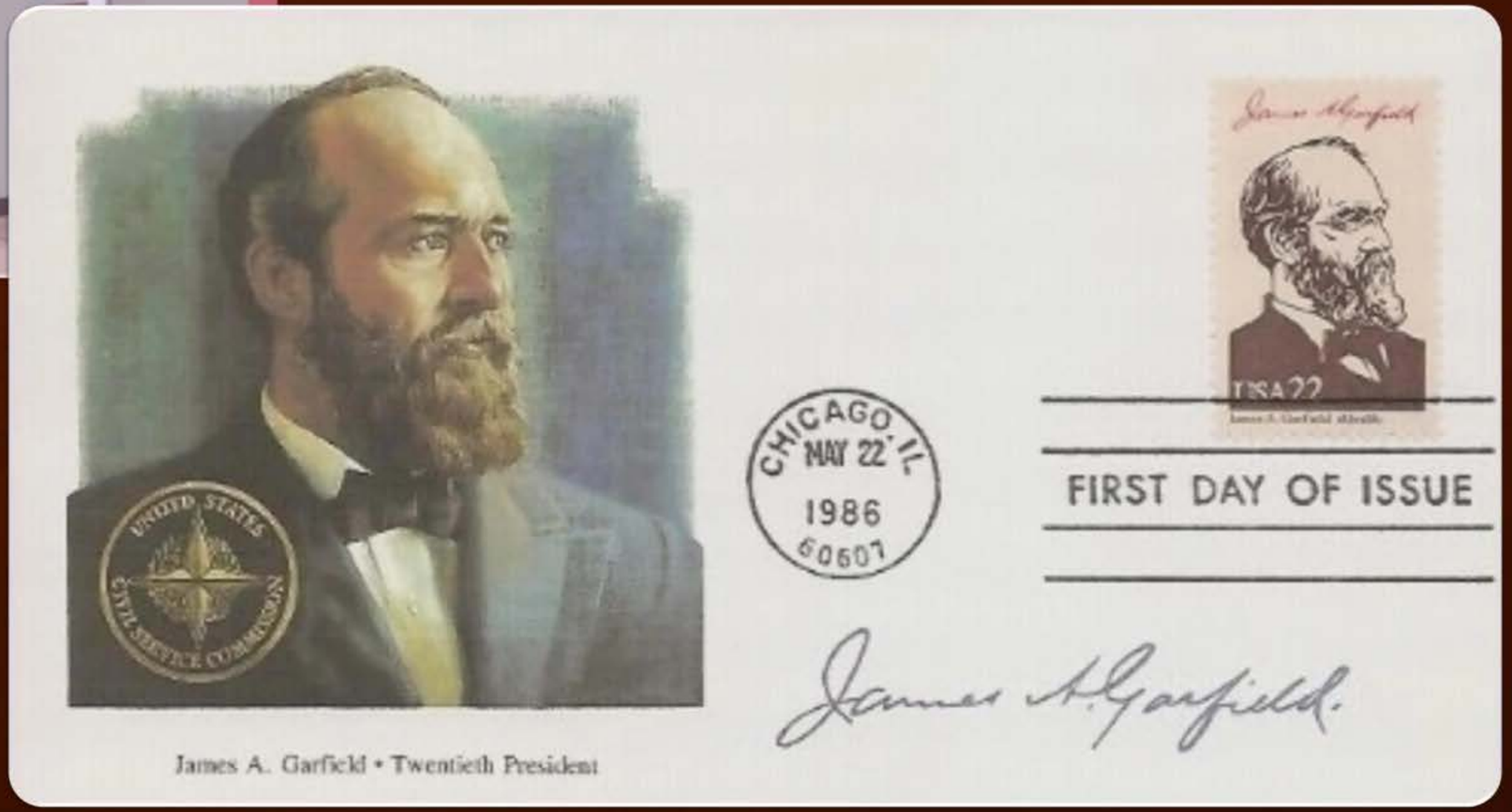
भारतीय डाक-तार विभाग INDIAN POSTS & TELEGRAPHS







TICKET COUNTER
Work timings
8AM to 5PM (Sleeper Class)


UNITED STATES
CIVIL SERVICE COMMISSION
CHICAGO, IL
MAY 22
1986
60607
USA 22
FIRST DAY OF ISSUE
James A. Garfield
James A. Garfield • Twentieth President

941 Willard Street

Galesburg, Illinois

July 18, 1894

Sam

Charley

I got to wishing that you were right. Then I got to believing you were right. And, Charley, it's true; I found the third level! I've been here two weeks, and right now, down the street at the Daly's, someone is playing a piano, and they're all out on the front porch singing 'Seeing Nelly Home.' And I'm invited over for lemonade. Come on back, Charley and Louisa. Keep looking till you find the third level! It's worth it, believe me!

old currency shop
↓
800 dollars
↓
new business
↓
Hay & grain



2nd level

→ Alley way

# Topic : The Third Level

## 1. Introduction and Setting the Tone

- Narrator: Charlie, a 31-year-old man living in New York.
- He begins by talking about how time-travel is possible, even though his psychiatrist friend Sam doesn't agree.
- He introduces the central idea — a mysterious Third Level at Grand Central Station, which supposedly doesn't exist in the real world.

**Important Line:**

"I was trying to get home. I got lost. That's easy to do. I've been in and out of Grand Central hundreds of times."

# Topic : The Third Level

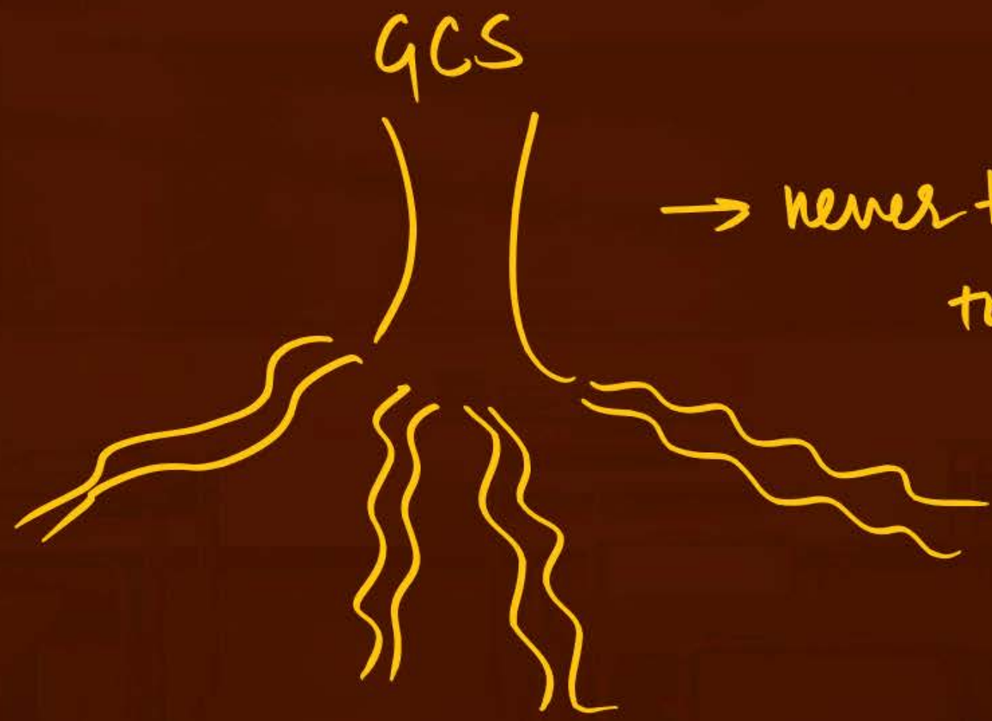
## 2. Description of Grand Central Station – Symbol of Confusion

- Grand Central is described as a maze with many corridors, stairways, tunnels – people have lost their way there. puzzle
- Charlie uses this imagery to make the idea of discovering a third level seem believable.

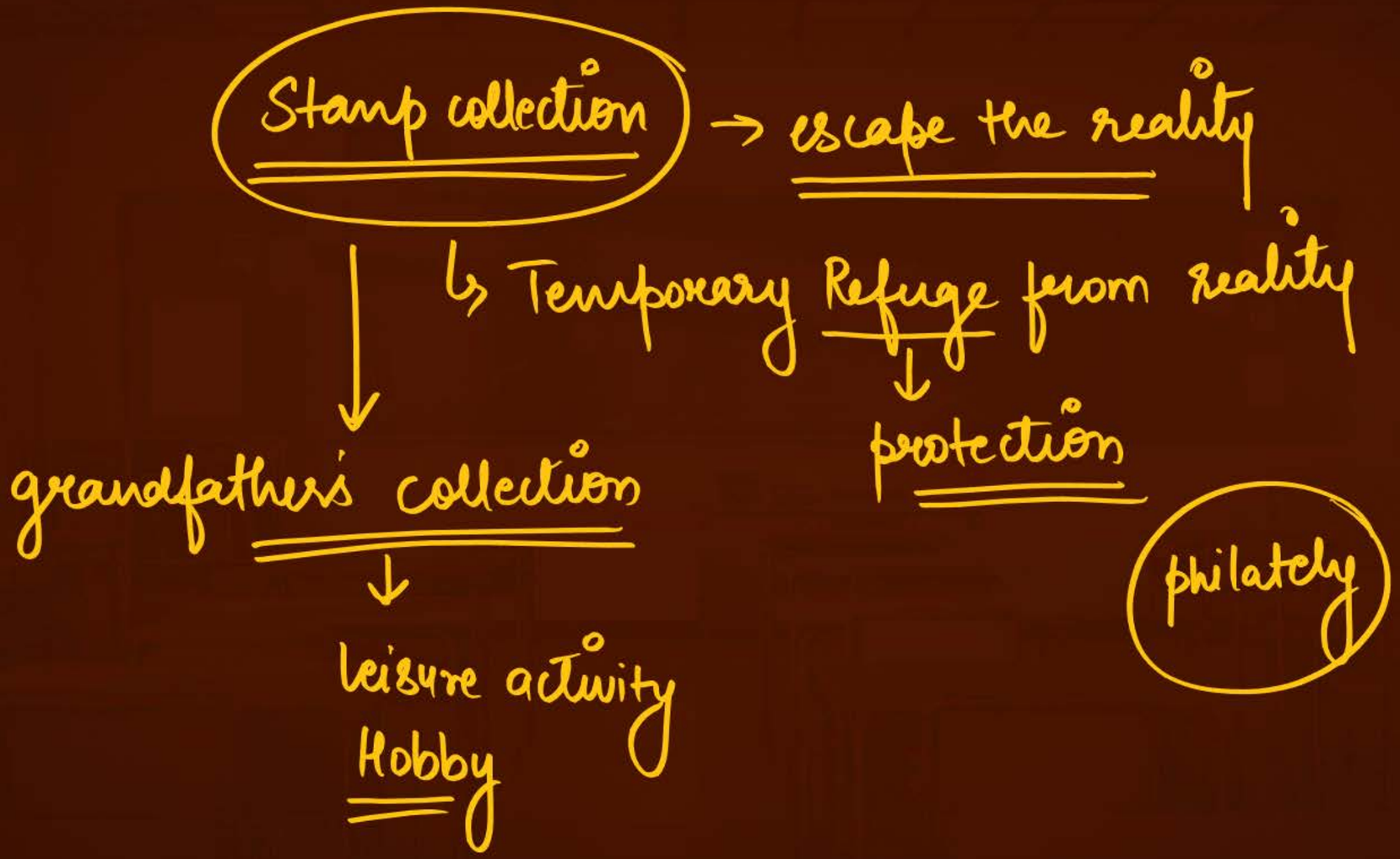
**Key Detail:** The author uses this confusion to plant the seed that Charlie's experience could be real or imagined. Charley's Idea

"It's always pushing out in new directions – like a tree, pushing out new corridors and staircases." → A tree pushing new roots.

( central park




→ never told this thought to his psychiatrist.


Stamp collection
→ escape the reality
↳ Temporary Refuge from reality
protection
grandfather's collection
leisure activity
Hobby
philately

# Topic : The Third Level

### 3. The Discovery of the Third Level

- One evening, Charlie is in a rush to get home.
- He takes a route he's never taken before – a staircase leading down, not familiar.
- The ambiance begins to change – the lights are dim things seem old-fashioned.
- Brass spittoons, beards, handlebar moustaches, old currency.
- He realizes he is in the year 1894.





verification → newspaper

The world

after
world war 2

1950-60

11 June, 1894 ✓✓

3rd level - past

# Topic : The Third Level

**Important Line:**

"There were open flame gaslights and brass spittoons... people wore derby hats and fancy moustaches... the locomotive had a funnel-shaped stack."

currier & ives locomotive



**Literary Element:**

- Surrealism begins to blend with historical realism — Charlie is either hallucinating, dreaming, or actually time-traveling.

# Topic : The Third Level

### 4. Buying Tickets to Galesburg, Illinois (1894)

- Charlie tries to buy tickets to Galesburg, a peaceful town from the 1890s.
- He wants to escape from modern stress — wars, insecurity, etc.
- But the clerk refuses his modern currency (the bills are different from 1894).
- Charlie realizes he needs to get old-style currency to travel.

Charley's childhood place

he ran away

he offers currency

threatened to get him arrested

1894 - peaceful

WW1 — 20 years away

WW2 — 30-40 years away

# Topic : The Third Level

**Important Line:**

"The clerk figured the fare — and I counted out the money. But he looked at the bills, and he glanced up at me and nodded and went to the back..."

notes

**Key Insight:**

Charlie gets scared when the clerk fetches a policeman — he runs back, returns to the present.

currency exchange shop

300 dollars

↓ Exchange — old style bills

less than 200 dollars

1894 is cheaper

↓

He went back to 3rd level

# Topic : The Third Level

### 5. Charlie's Desire to Return and His Obsession

- After the incident, Charlie becomes obsessed with the Third Level.
- He visits the station night after night hoping to find it again, but fails.
- He discusses this with his psychiatrist friend Sam, who tells him it's all a result of "waking-dream wish fulfillment" – a way of escaping reality.

खुली आँखो से सपना

Twist

↓

Friend

↓

Sam - disappear ✓

# Topic : The Third Level

**Important Explanation:**

Waking-dream wish fulfillment means the experience was a fantasy or subconscious desire, not real.

"The modern world is full of insecurity, fear, war, worry – and all the rest of it... That's what he said it was: a waking-dream wish fulfillment."

# Topic : The Third Level

### 6. The Twist – Sam Disappears

- Later, Sam (his psychiatrist friend) goes missing.
- Charlie is told that Sam has gone to Galesburg, 1894, and is now running a hay, feed, and grain business.
- Sam used to be a city psychiatrist but apparently preferred the peaceful life of the past.

Sam -> psychiatrist friend

unstable - more ✓

Third level -> portal for time Travel ✓

Hogwartz
↓
Stairs -> more ✓

Letter

grandfather paradox

Change the past → present change

Sam did this

He wrote a letter → collection में add

1894 → present

First Day covers

A new stamp is issued ✓



empty envelopes

Stamp collectors

↓

newstamp → paste on a empty envelope

↓

Mail to self

↓

Record

Charley found a 1st day cover that never existed ✓

Strange - it was not empty

it was a letter

→ Mailed to grandfather ✓

→ Referred to charley. ✓

18 July, 1894

11 June, 1894

# Topic : The Third Level

**Important Line:**

"He said that one night he got to the Third Level – he bought old-style currency and bought tickets to Galesburg."

- Charlie discovers this through a first-day cover (an envelope sent on a specific date) mailed from 1894 — proof?

# Topic : The Third Level

## 7. Charlie Collects Old Currency

- Convinced that the Third Level is real, Charlie begins collecting old currency to try again.
- He longs for the simpler past, idealizing the 1890s.



"I've got two hundred old-style bills... and I'm going back to the Third Level to buy those two tickets."



# Topic : The Third Level

## Key Themes in Detail

| | |
|---|---|
| **Escapism** | Charlie wants to escape from the harsh modern reality of wars, insecurity, and stress. The Third Level is a metaphor for his desire to live in a simpler time. |
| **Time Travel vs. Psychological Illusion** | The story blurs the line between reality and imagination. Is the Third Level real, or just a figment of Charlie's troubled mind? |
| **Nostalgia for the Past** | The 1890s are portrayed as peaceful, slow-paced, and secure. It contrasts with modern chaos. |
| **Modern Anxieties** | Charlie represents every modern man overwhelmed by technology, fast-paced life, and uncertainty. |

# Topic : The Third Level

## 🧩 Possible Endings & Interpretations

### 🧠 Interpretation 1: The Third Level is Real

- Sam's letter from 1894 proves that time-travel is possible.
- Charlie might discover it again and escape with Louisa to the past.

### 🧠 Interpretation 2: It's All in Charlie's Mind

- The Third Level and the letter are his coping mechanism.
- He suffers from delusional escapism – even Sam's "letter" could be imagined.

# Topic : The Third Level

### 🧠 Interpretation 3: Open Ending – Blurred Realities

- The story ends without confirming whether the Third Level is real or fantasy.
- Finney leaves it to reader interpretation, making the story mystical and haunting.

# Topic : The Third Level

## 📘 Narrative Style and Language

- First-person narration – makes the story feel personal and intimate.
- Language is descriptive and realistic but with subtle surrealism.
- Blends historical facts with imagination.

# Topic : The Third Level

## 📌 Important Lines for Classroom Use

1. “The Presidents of the railroads have to be taken off the trains and locked up.”
2. “It’s a temporary refuge from reality.”
3. “I wish I’d lived in those days. Everything was so quiet and peaceful.”
4. “The world was full of insecurity, fear, war, worry – and all the rest of it.”
5. “I’m going back there – to the Third Level – to buy two tickets to Galesburg.”

# Topic : The Third Level

## 🧠 Character Analysis

### 👤 Charlie

- 31 years old; married to Louisa.
- Represents a man dissatisfied with modern life.
- Possibly suffering from anxiety and escapist fantasies.
- Symbol of the modern individual's craving for simplicity.

anxious, insecure, scared

galesburg → childhood place

# Topic : The Third Level

### Louisa

- Charlie's wife; supportive and concerned.
- Appears only briefly but is a symbol of Charlie's desire for stability

purchase 2 tickets

# Topic : The Third Level

### Sam Weiner

- A psychiatrist; Charlie's friend.
- His disappearance adds mystery and twist. - deceiving friend
- Suggests that even rational people want to escape sometimes.

he was also dissatisfied from his life.

# Topic : The Third Level

## 🧪 Conclusion

- **“The Third Level”** is not just a **sci-fi story**. It is a psychological exploration of escapism, a metaphor for nostalgia, and a symbol of the universal human desire to flee from life’s pressures.

- It teaches students that sometimes **“what we think we see”** might be less about reality and more about what we wish were true.

# Topic : The Third Level

**More about Sam's disappearance**

- Sam had bought eight hundred dollars' worth of old-style currency
- money sufficient to set him up in a little hay, feed and grain business
- Sam can't go back to old business since psychiatry was not known as a profession in Galesburg of 1894

# Topic : The Third Level

**Lay covers?**

- stamp collectors affix new stamp on an envelope
- mail the envelope to themselves on the first day of sale
- the postmark gives proof of the day
- envelope never opened, nothing written

# Topic : The Third Level

**Narrator finds a strange first-day cover in his collection**

- a strange cover mailed to narrator's grandfather's address in Galesburg
- it is dated July 18,1894
- the six-cent stamp bears the picture of President Garfield
- the envelope contains letter for Charley by his friend Sam
- Sam confirms presence of the third level
- Sam invites Charley and Louisa to join him in Galesburg
- advises to keep looking for third level till it is found

# Topic : The Third Level

**Futile search for the Third Level**

- attempt, narrator fails to find the corridor leading to the third level
- tells everything to his wife who is worried
- she dissuades him and he stops search
- resumes stamp collection as a hobby

# Topic : The Third Level

**Charley seeks Third Level again**

- gets proof of the third level's existence owing to his friend Sam Weiner's disappearance
- now both husband and wife look for the third level platforms on weekends
- narrator recalls telling Sam about Galesburg
- the narrator believes that Sam is now in Galesburg. in the year 1894

# Topic : The Third Level

**Charley buys old currency**

- withdraws three hundred dollars from bank next day
- buys old-style currency
- his psychiatrist friend gets worried
- however, Charley's three hundred dollars fetch less than two hundred in old-
- style bills
- wants to go back to the third level to travel to Galesburg, Illinois

# Topic : The Third Level

**Futile search for the Third Level**

- in his second attempt, narrator fails to find the corridor leading to the third level
- tells everything to his wife who is worried
- she dissuades him and he stops search
- resumes stamp collection as a hobby

# Topic : The Third Level

**Charley loses his way and reaches the third level**

- Charley works late one summer night in office
- keen to get back home to his wife Louisa
- in a hurry to board a train goes down to the second level
- crosses the arched doorway for the subway
- loses his way
- feels Grand Central grows like a tree and pushes out new corridors and stairs
- narrator walks down a corridor
- hears empty sound of his own footsteps
- finds himself on the third level at Grand Central Station

# Topic : The Third Level

- finds smaller rooms, fewer ticket windows and open-flame gaslights
- everybody at the station dressed in 19 th century dresses
- finds lead story about President Cleveland in Paper, The World dated June 11, 1894
- goes to the ticket window and demands two tickets for Galesburg, Illinois
- wants to go there with his wife Louisa
- imagines the town in the year 1894 and thinks First World War still twenty years
- off and Second World War still forty years ahead
- his currency bills not accepted; the clerk gets angry
- runs away to escape jail

# Topic : The Third Level

**Three Levels of Grand Central Station**

- the narrator feels there are three levels at Grand Central Railway Station, New York
- there are, in fact, only two levels
- his psychiatrist friend tells him it is a wakingdream wish fulfillment
- says that modern man is full of insecurity; wants an escape

# Topic : The Third Level

**Narrator's hobby of stamp collection**

- according to the psychiatrist it was a 'temporary refuge from reality
- the narrator finds it hard to believe
- argues that grandfather needed no refuge from reality; was contented, yet he pursued philately
- there was no insecurity in good old days as we know it today

# Topic : The Third Level

**way and reaches the third level**

- Charley works late one summer night in office
- keen to get back home to his wife Louisa
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# Topic : The Third Level

- finds smaller rooms, fewer ticket windows and open-flame gaslights
- everybody at the station dressed in 19 th century dresses
- finds lead story about President Cleveland in Paper, The World' dated June 11, 1894
- goes to the ticket window and demands two tickets for Galesburg, Illinois
- wants to go there with his wife Louisa

# QUESTION

#Q. Who is the author of The Third Level?

1. George Orwell
2. Agatha Christie
3. James Joyee
4. Jack Finney ✓

(4)



# QUESTION

#Q. What is the meaning of 'Waking dream wish fulfilment"?

Hallucinate.

1. A pleasant wish that makes one forget the present ✓
   Hallucinate
2. A pleasant wish that takes one to the future
3. A pleasant wish which inspires to work
4. A pleasant wish that makes one forget the past ✗



# QUESTION

#Q. CHARLIE was in hurry to go home to his _____.

1. Mom
2. Father
3. Brother
4. Wife



# QUESTION

#Q. What is "Waking dream wish fulfilment" according to the psychiatrist in the lesson?

1. Charles finding of a Third level at Grand Central Stationed realization of his wish to visit Galesburg Illinois
2. Charles escapism
3. Charles escapism from realities
4. None



# QUESTION

#Q. How old is charley?

1. 30 years
2. 29 years
3. 32 years
4. 31 years



# QUESTION

#Q. what is the theme of the lesson?

1. Human tendency of escapism because of the harsh realities of the present (main theme)
2. Time travelling → Secondary theme. we apprehend
3. Theory of escapism
4. A dialogue between a patient and a psychiatrist

(A)



# QUESTION

#Q. What was Jack's full name?

1. Walter Braden Jack Finey
2. Stephen Jone Jack
3. Ray Douglas Bradbury
4. None



# QUESTION

#Q. What is Sam's letter to Charles represent?

1. A blend
2. An acceptance to visit
3. A proof of his fantasy
4. A blend of reality with fantasy



# QUESTION

#Q. Why was the narrator seeing this Third Level?

1. As a wish to visit Galesburg
2. Wanted to meet his friends
3. Wanted to take a break from office
4. As a result of stress and anxiety in his mind



# QUESTION

#Q. Why was Louisa, Charley's wife worried?

1. Knowing the incident of Third Level
2. For not getting tickets
3. Tickets were delayed
4. Sam was scaring



# QUESTION

#Q. What specific difference did Charley notice at the Third Level of Central Station?

1. Everything was weird ✗
2. Everything was old styled and smaller in size ✓ (B)
3. Everything was too big
4. Everything was shining



# QUESTION

#Q. What was Sam invited for according to the letter?

1. For a party
2. For a tea party
3. For a bachelor's party
4. For a lemonade party



# QUESTION

#Q. Charley came out in the lobby of _____ hotel.

1. Raddison
2. Hyatt
3. Roosevelt
4. Not mentioned



# QUESTION

#Q. Why it seemed that Charley was mad?

1. He wanted to escape from reality
2. He discovered a third level at the station
3. He wanted to go to Galesburg of 1894
4. All of these



# QUESTION

#Q. What was Charley's 'temporary refuge from reality'?

refuge → protection

Last poll

1. Reading ✗
2. Spending time with Louisa ✗
3. Stamp collection ✓
4. All of these

Hobby of stamp collection is called philately.

(3)



# QUESTION

#Q. Charley compares the Grand Central Station to a _____.

1. flower
2. tree
3. plant
4. ball



# QUESTION

#Q. Which of these is the name of a train?

1. Vanderbilt Avenue
2. Twentieth Century
3. New Haven
4. Grand Central



# QUESTION

#Q. To know that her husband was unhappy, Louisa felt _____.

1. unhappy
2. hopeless
3. sad
4. joyful



# QUESTION

#Q. Did Charley's friends agree with Sam that everyone wants to escape?

1. No
2. Yes
3. Not mentioned
4. Both (A) and (B)



# QUESTION

#Q. Why did Charley's grandfather not need a refuge from reality?

1. It was peaceful then
2. He earned more
3. Life was relaxed because he didn't have kids
4. He was uneducated



# QUESTION

#Q. The man in the information booth wore _____ eyeshades.

1. red
2. blue
3. black
4. green



# QUESTION

#Q. Once Charley got into a mile-long tunnel and came out at _____.

1. Grand Central
2. Roosevelt hotel
3. Vanderbilt Avenue
4. Hartford Railroad



# QUESTION

#Q. The new corridors and staircases at the third level are like _____.

1. roots
2. hair
3. branches
4. All of these



# QUESTION

#Q. The lights at the third level were

1. bright
2. dim and flickering
3. bright and blinking
4. neon-coloured



# QUESTION

#Q. How did Charley first realize that he was in 1894?

1. the date on the newspaper
2. by looking at a man dressed in old-fashioned manner
3. The clerk rejected his new currency
4. he saw a locomotive with a funnel-shaped stack



# QUESTION

#Q. Identify the two meanings of ‘stack’ as used in the story

1. a pile, chimney
2. chimney, a pile
3. engine, chimney
4. a pile, engine



# QUESTION

#Q. Who was the President in 1894?

1. Roosevelt
2. Cleveland
3. Both (A) and (B)
4. None of these



# QUESTION

#Q. Find one word for – “Trees whose branches meet overhead and roof the street”

1. Canopy
2. Bower
3. Both (A) and (B)
4. None of these



# QUESTION

#Q. The modern world is full of insecurity, fear, war, worry and stress. What are the ways in which we attempt to overcome them?

**Ans.** Man often creates in his fantasy a world which is somewhere between his desire and reality, and often seeks respite by transporting himself to it mentally. Time travel is another way of overcoming stress; we travel back in time to the past which we believe was a quieter and happier era. Nostalgic memories too are often a way of escape from the harassing present.

# QUESTION

#Q. Do you think that the third level was a medium of escape for Charley? Why?

**Ans.** Life today is full of insecurity, fear and worries and time travel is man's way of escaping from it. Occasionally, man seeks escape into the world of fantasy and his nostalgic memories, the happier times of the past. Yes, the third level was Charley's medium of escape from the mad rat race of modern times.

# QUESTION

#Q. Do you see an intersection of time and space in the story?

**Ans.** Yes, there are a lot of instances that tell us about the intersection of time and space in the story. First intersection being the one between the first two levels of the Grand Central Station and its third level which is based somewhere in the 1890 s whereas the former exists in the present times. Also when Charley went to buy tickets for Galesburg which existed in 1894 while he and his wife exists in the present times. Not to ignore the old-fashioned architecture of Q the third level in contradiction to the modern interiors of the first two levels. Lastly, the letter dated 18th July, 1982 that Charley found also throws light upon the intersection of time and space as both the sender (Sam) and the receiver (Charley) exist in the present times.

# QUESTION

#Q. Do you think that the third level was a medium of escape for Charley? Why?

**Ans.** Yes, the third level of the Grand Central Station was a medium of escape for Charley.

Modern world offers a lot of challenges and in order to take refuge from reality, one might resort to day-dreaming or hallucination We all understand the miseries of the modern world which is full of worry and pressure, thus, in order to take the burden away from his shoulders and heap a sigh of relief, Charley resorted to escaping reality, although unintentionally.

# QUESTION

#Q. What does the third level refer to?

**Ans.** Third level refers to an additional floor at the Grand Central Station which originally only had two levels. Charley was hallucinating one night while going home when he reached $Q$ the third level.

# QUESTION

#Q. Would Charley ever go back to the ticket counter on the third level to buy tickets to Galesburg for himself and his wife?

**Ans.** Charley went looking back for the third level that could take him and his wife to Galesburg because he wanted to go back to his past. He wanted to go back to the world that has not seen two of its deadliest wars that changed everything.

# QUESTION

#Q. What does the third level refer to? What is the significance of the third level?

**Ans.** The third level is a medium of escape through which man yearns to be away from life's harsh realities. Modem life is devoid of peace and tranquility so man in his quest to seek solace escapes to a place where his aim is to seek the realization of his dreams and unfulfilled wishes of his subconscious mind.

# QUESTION

#Q. How does Charley, the narrator describe the third level at Grand Central Station?

**Ans.** Charley says that the rooms on the third level were smaller than that of the second level. There were fewer ticket windows and train gates and the information booth in the centre was wood and old looking. There were open- flame gaslights and brass spittoons on the floor. Everyone at the station was dressed in nineteenth century dresses.

# QUESTION

#Q. Why did Charley suspect that Sam had gone to Galesburg?

**Ans.** When Sam disappeared all of a sudden and no one knew about his whereabouts, Charley suspected he had gone to Galesburg as Sam was a city boy and liked Galesburg very much. Then Charley found an envelope mailed to Sam by his grandfather from his home in Galesburg and so it confirmed that Sam was indeed in Galesburg.

# QUESTION

#Q. Why did the booking clerk refuse to accept the money?

**Ans.** The booking clerk refuses to accept the money because the notes Charley had given him were of old style. He did not pay in the currency notes that were in circulation in 1894. So the clerk stared at him and told him, “That ain’t money, Mister”. He thought Charley was trying to cheat him and even threatened to get him arrested.

# QUESTION

#Q. What did Charley learn about Sam from the stamp and coin store?

**Ans.** From the stamp and coin store Charley gets to know that Sam had bought old style currency worth eight hundred dollars. This money was sufficient to set him up in a little hay, feed and grain business in Galesburg.

# QUESTION

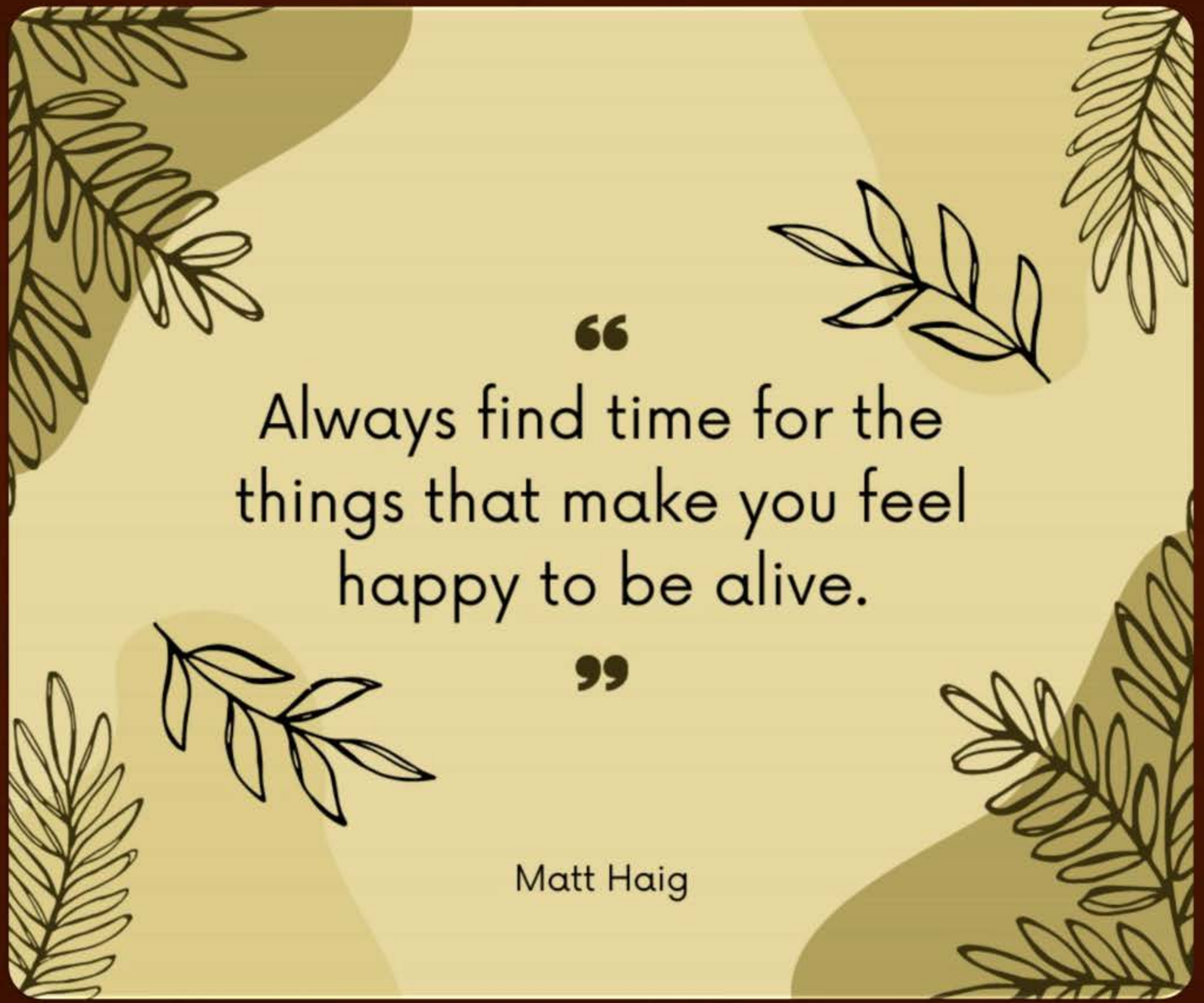
#Q. What is being inferred from Sam's letter to Charley?

**Ans.** Sam's letter to Charley is dated 18th July, 1894. It is written from Galesburg, Illinois. In response to Charley's claim of having visited the third level, Sam who is equally insecure wishes the entire episode is true, as he too believes in the existence of the third level. There are some inferences made by the letter. The introductory part of the letter confirms Charley's belief in the existence of the third level. It also suggests that those who find the third level can travel across to Galesburg and enjoy the festivities, songs, music and peaceful world of the 1890s. So the author uses Sam's letter as a unique combination of the real and fantasy world.

# QUESTION

#Q. How does Charley make his description of the third level very realistic?

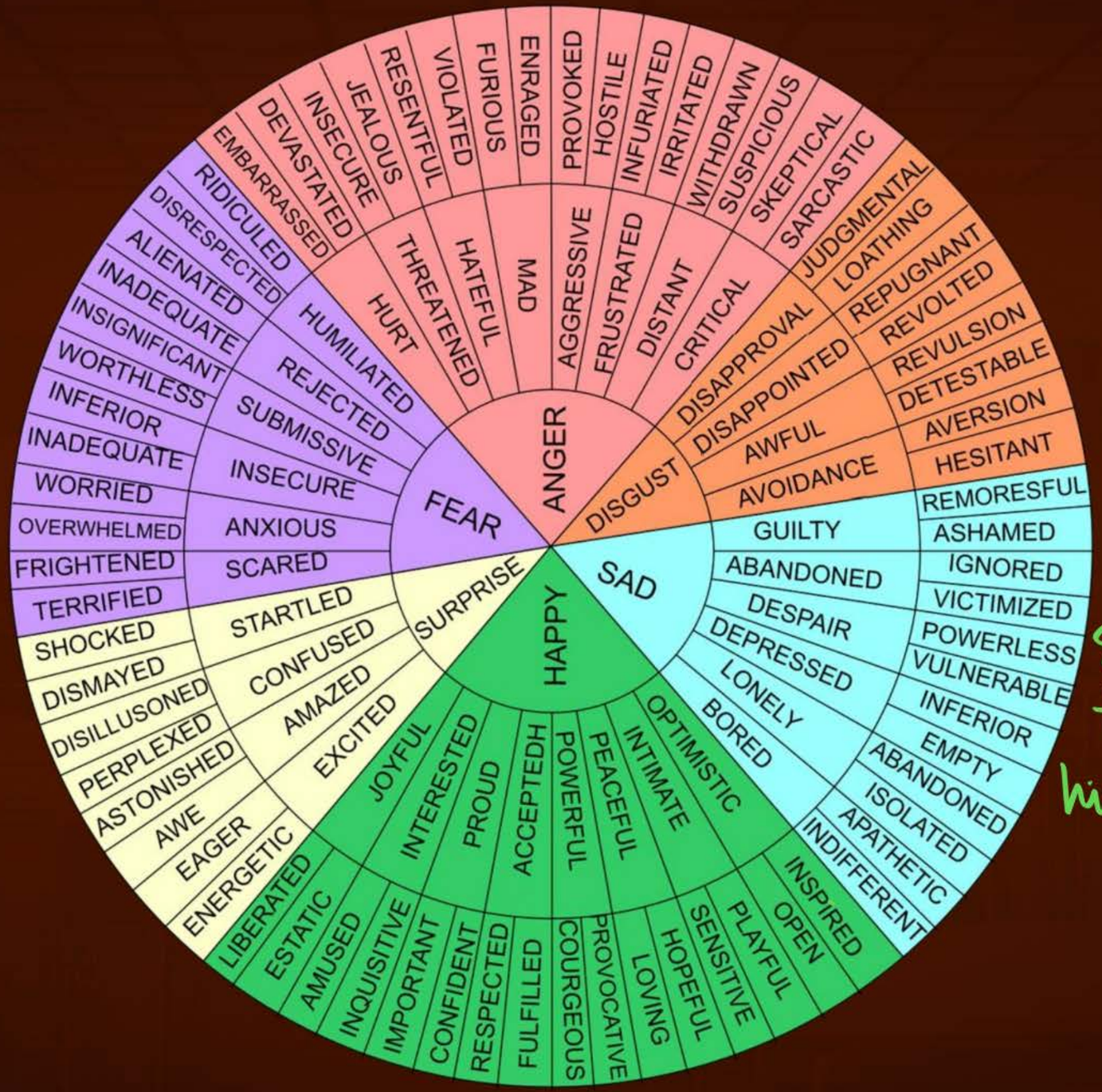
**Ans.** To make his description of the third level very realistic, Charley describes its minute details, vividly comparing it to the second level of the Grand Central station. He says the rooms here were smaller. There were fewer ticket windows and train gates, and the information booth was wooden and old-looking. He also gives a detailed description about the people he saw at the third level and their dresses. He says the people wore nineteenth century dresses; many men had beards, sideburns and fancy moustaches. He also buys tickets to Galesburg, Illinois thus making the reader believe that he was actually at the third level.


“
Always find time for the
things that make you feel
happy to be alive.
”
Matt Haig

QOTD .


BYE, BYE.

The storm threatened us yet the sun inspired.




Threatened

inspired

Even threatend the world but inspired his country's people

# THANK YOU

DPP

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